

THE USA, 1954-75: VIETNAM

Source Booklet

Key Topic 3: US Involvement in the Vietnam War, 1954-75

Reasons For US Involvement In The Conflict In Vietnam, 1954-63

Source: President Dwight D. Eisenhower press conference, April 7 1954. Eisenhower is responding to a question from a reporter about the 'strategic importance of Indochina to the free world.'

Finally, you have broader considerations that might follow what you would call the "falling domino" principle. You have a row of dominoes set up, you knock over the first one, and what will happen to the last one is the certainty that it will go over very quickly. So you could have a beginning of a disintegration that would have the most profound influences.

Now, with respect to the first one, two of the items from this particular area that the world uses are tin and tungsten. They are very important. There are others, of course, the rubber plantations and so on.

Then with respect to more people passing under this domination, Asia, after all, has already lost some 450 million of its peoples to the Communist dictatorship, and we simply can't afford greater losses.

But when we come to the possible sequence of events, the loss of Indochina, of Burma, of Thailand, of the Peninsula, and Indonesia following, now you begin to talk about areas that not only multiply the disadvantages that you would suffer through loss of materials, sources of materials, but now you are talking really about millions and millions and millions of people.

Finally, the geographical position achieved thereby does many things. It turns the so-called island defensive chain of Japan, Formosa, of the Philippines and to the southward; it moves in to threaten Australia and New Zealand.

It takes away, in its economic aspects, that region that Japan must have as a trading area or Japan, in turn, will have only one place in the world to go--that is, toward the Communist areas in order to live.

So, the possible consequences of the loss are just incalculable to the free world.

Source: President Dwight D. Eisenhower discussing the importance of Indochina to America's interests, August 4, 1953. (President Eisenhower's Remarks at Governors' Conference, August 4, 1953, *Public Papers of the Presidents*, 1953, p. 540)

"Why is it? Now, first of all, the last great population remaining in Asia that has not become dominated by the Kremlin, of course, is the sub-continent of India, including the Pakistan government. Here are 350 million people still free. Now let us assume that we lose Indochina. If Indochina goes, several things happen right away. The Malayan peninsula, the last little bit of the end hanging on down there, would be scarcely defensible--and tin and tungsten that we so greatly value from that area would cease coming. But all India would be outflanked. Burma would certainly, in its weakened condition, be no defense. Now, India is surrounded on that side by the Communist empire. Iran on its left is in a weakened condition. I believe I read in the paper this morning that Mossadegh's move toward getting rid of his parliament has been supported and of course he was in that move supported by the Tudeh, which is the Communist Party of Iran. All of that weakening position around there is very

ominous for the United States, because finally if we lost all that, how would the free world hold the rich empire of Indonesia? So you see, somewhere along the line, this must be blocked. It must be blocked now.

"So, when the United States votes \$400 million to help that war, we are not voting for a giveaway program. We are voting for the cheapest way that we can to prevent the occurrence of something that would be of the most terrible significance for the United States of America--our security, our power and ability to get certain things we need from the riches of the Indonesian territory, and from southeast Asia."

Source: US, National Security Council, NSC 5405, "United States Objectives and Courses of Action With Respect to Southeast Asia," 16 January 1954, pp. 434-443. This memo outlines the objectives and plans of action of the United States in the South East Asia area.

"In the conflict in Indochina, the Communist and non-Communist worlds clearly confront one another on the field of battle. The loss of the struggle in Indochina, in addition to its impact in Southeast Asia and in South Asia, would therefore have the most serious repercussions on U. S. and free world interests in Europe and elsewhere."

"The loss of Southeast Asia would have serious economic consequences for many nations of the free world and conversely would add significant resources to the Soviet bloc. Southeast Asia, especially Malaya and Indonesia, is the principal world source of natural rubber and tin, and a producer of petroleum and other strategically important commodities. The rice exports of Burma, Indochina and Thailand are critically important to Malaya, Ceylon and Hong Kong and are of considerable significance to Japan and India, all important areas of free Asia. Furthermore, this area has an important potential as a market for the industrialized countries of the free world."

Source: President John F. Kennedy's Address to American Society of Newspaper Editors, April 20, 1961. Kennedy is discussing the threats to security that America faces around the world. (President Kennedy's Address to American Society of Newspaper Editors, April 20, 1961, *Public Papers of the Presidents*, Kennedy, 1961, p. 306)

"The message of Cuba, of Laos, of the rising din of Communist voices in Asia and Latin America--these messages are all the same. The complacent, the self-indulgent, the soft societies are about to be swept away with the debris of history. Only the strong, only the industrious, only the determined, only the courageous, only the visionary who determine the real nature of our struggle can possibly survive.

"No greater task faces this country or this administration. No other challenge is more deserving of our every effort and energy. Too long we have fixed our eyes on traditional military needs, on armies prepared to cross borders, on missiles poised for flight. Now it should be clear that this is no longer enough--that our security may be lost piece by piece, country by country, without the firing of a single missile or the crossing of a single border.

Source: President John F. Kennedy's Address, in Chicago to the Democratic Party Dinner, April 28, 1961. Kennedy is discussing the situation in Vietnam, and Americas potential response. (President Kennedy's Address, in Chicago to Democratic Party Dinner, April 28, 1961, *Public Papers of the Presidents*, Kennedy, 1961, p. 340)

"Tonight, in Vietnam, where the President was re-elected recently in the last 2 weeks by a majority of 75 to 80 percent, yet a small army of guerrillas, organized and sustained by the Communist Viet Minh in the north, control most of the countryside in the nighttime--in the last 12 months have assassinated over four thousand civil officers, two thousand state employees and two thousand police, believing if they can 'spill the wine,' that then they can win control of the population. And when they have won, they do not intend to give way.

"Now our great responsibility is to be the chief defender of freedom, in this time of maximum danger. Only the United States has the power and the resources and the determination. We have committed ourselves to the defense of dozens of countries stretched around the globe who look to us for independence, who look to us for the defense of their freedom.

Source: Joint Communiqué Issued at Saigon by the Vice President of the United States and the President of Viet-Nam, May 13, 1961. This document affirms the support of the United States for South Vietnam.

"The United States, for its part, is conscious of the determination, energy and sacrifices which the Vietnamese people, under the dedicated leadership of President Ngo Dinh Diem, have brought to the defense of freedom in their land.

"The United States is also conscious of its responsibility and duty, in its own self-interest as well as in the interest of other free peoples, to assist a brave country in the defense of its liberties against unprovoked subversion and Communist terror. It has no other motive than the defense of freedom."

Source: President John F. Kennedy's letter to President Ngo Dinh Diem of South Vietnam. Kennedy is expressing his strong support for Diem.

December 14, 1961

Dear Mr. President:

I have received your recent letter in which you described so cogently the dangerous conditions caused by North Vietnam's effort to take over your country. The situation in your embattled country is well known to me and to the American people. We have been deeply disturbed by the assault on your country. Our indignation has mounted as the deliberate savagery of the Communist programs of assassination, kidnapping, and wanton violence became clear.

Your letter underlines what our own information has convincingly shown - that the campaign of force and terror now being waged against your people and your Government is supported and directed from outside by the authorities at Hanoi. They have thus violated the provisions of the Geneva Accords designed to ensure peace in Vietnam and to which they bound themselves in 1954.

At that time, the United States, although not a party to the Accords, declared that it "would view any renewal of the aggression in violation of the Agreements with grave concern and as seriously threatening international peace and security." We continue to maintain that view.

In accordance with that declaration, and in response to your request, we are prepared to help the Republic of Vietnam to protect its people and to preserve its

independence. We shall promptly increase our assistance to your defense effort as well as help relieve the destruction of the floods which you describe. I have already given the orders to get these programs underway.

The United States, like the Republic of Vietnam, remains devoted to the cause of peace and our primary purpose is to help your people maintain their independence. If the Communist authorities in North Vietnam will stop their campaign to destroy the Republic of Vietnam, the measures we are taking to assist your defense efforts will no longer be necessary. We shall seek to persuade the Communists to give up their attempts to force and subversion. In any case, we are confident that the Vietnamese people will preserve their independence and gain the peace and prosperity for which they have sought so hard and so long.

Source: Ambassador to South Vietnam Henry Cabot Lodge telegram to Secretary of State Dean Rusk regarding President Diem's impending doom, 29 August 1963. *The Pentagon Papers*, Gravel Edition, Volume 2, pp. 738-739

"We are launched on a course from which there is no respectable turning back: the overthrow of the Diem government. There is no turning back in part because U.S. prestige is already publicly committed to this end in large measure and will become more so as the facts leak out. In a more fundamental sense, there is no turning back because there is no possibility, in my view, that the war can be won under a Diem administration, still less that Diem or any member of the family can govern the country in a way to gain the support of the people who count, i.e., the educated class in and out of government service, civil and military-not to mention the American people. In the last few months (and especially days) they have in fact positively alienated these people to an incalculable degree. So that I am personally in full agreement with the policy which I was instructed to carry out by last Sunday's telegram."



French parachutists watch comrades being dropped over Dien Bien Phu.



Captured French soldiers are escorted by Vietnamese troops to the POW camp.

"All the News
That's Fit to Print"

The New York Times.

LATE CITY EDITION
D. S. Weather Bureau Report, Page 11: Breeze
Cloudy, cool and windy today; fair
and colder tonight. Fair tomorrow.
Temp. range: 52-61; yesterday: 53-60.

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TEN CENTS

RUSSIANS REPORT LAUNCHING CRAFT THAT SHIFTS ORBIT

Major Advance Is Claimed
for Rendezvous in Space
—More Shots Predicted

KHRUSHCHEV JUBILANT

He Expresses Support for
a U.S.-Soviet Lunar Trip
if Tensions Are Eased

By THEODORE SHARAD

Special to The New York Times

MOSCOW, Nov. 1.—The Soviet Union announced the launching today of a new type of maneuverable satellite in a major step toward perfecting rendezvous techniques in space. Shortly afterward Premier Khrushchev indicated support for a joint Soviet-American moon project.

The unmanned earth-controlled spaceship, called Polyt 1, or Flight 1, appeared to have the same capability as that sought in the United States Gemini project, which is still under development.

It reportedly performed extensive horizontal and vertical maneuvers that moved it from its initial nearly circular orbit with an apogee (maximum distance from earth) of 368 miles to a greatly elongated orbit with an apogee of 862 miles.

There was no indication whether the satellite was being used as a telemeter from the charges.

14 Indicted on L. I. In Party Vandalism

Special to The New York Times
RIVERHEAD, L. I., Nov. 1.—Thirteen young men and one young woman were indicted today for causing \$3,202 worth of damage at a Southampton mansion after a debutante party on the night of Aug. 31. Several are members of prominent families in New York and Philadelphia.

A Suffolk County grand jury charged them with destruction of property, a misdemeanor carrying upon conviction a maximum penalty of six months in jail and a \$250 fine. District Attorney Bernard C. Smith said the 14 would be permitted to surrender voluntarily next Friday. But, he said, he will seek to extradite any of those living outside the state who do not.

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INSURRECTION LAW IN GEORGIA VOIDED

U.S. Court Prohibits, 2 to 1,
Trial of 4 in Americas—
Integrationists Bailed

By CLAUDE SEITON

Special to The New York Times

AMERICUS, Ga., Nov. 1.—A Federal court handed down an injunction today prohibiting the prosecution of four civil rights workers on state insurrection charges.

SENATE REFUSES TO ASK DEEP CUT FOR FOREIGN AID

Turns Back, 46-29, Motion
by Morse Urging Revision
of Bill by Committee

By FELIX BELAIR JR.

WASHINGTON, Nov. 1.—The Senate rallied behind its leaders today and blocked a move by dissenting Democrats to return the \$1.5 billion foreign aid authorization to the Foreign Relations Committee for possibly heavy pruning.

In a 46-29 vote it rejected a recommittal motion by Senator Wayne Morse and set the stage for a favorable vote next week on a proposal to cut the authorization by \$353 million.

The proposal, designed to head off even deeper cuts on the floor, was lampooned by Mr. Morse, Democrat of Oregon, as the "powerhouse amendment."

The plan was put before the Senate late yesterday by Senators Mike Mansfield and Everett McKinley Dirksen, the Democratic and Republican leaders, respectively. It was cosponsored by the two top-ranking members of both parties on the Foreign Relations Committee.

Morse Is Ridiculed

Senator Dirksen mocked and ridiculed Senator Morse and his recommittal motion with mimicry and sarcasm. Although Mr. Dirksen left the Senators and gallery spectators rocking with laughter, Mr. Morse appeared more determined than ever to

REBELS IN VIETNAM OUST DIEM, REPORT HIM AND NHU SUICIDES; SHARPER FIGHT ON REDS VOWED

Czechs, Malaysians To Split U.N. Term

By ALEXANDER BURNHAM

Special to The New York Times

UNITED NATIONS, N. Y., Nov. 1.—The General Assembly gave its approval today to a gentlemen's agreement whereby Czechoslovakia and Malaysia would split a two-year term on the Security Council. It then elected Czechoslovakia for the first year.

The approval followed 11 ballots by the Assembly on Oct. 18 and Oct. 25 in an effort to choose between the two.

After two weeks of consultations with other countries, the Czechs and Malaysians agreed to share the term.

Before today's secret vote the Assembly president, Dr. Carlos Ross Rodriguez, said that if the delegations agreed to the arrangement Czechoslovakia would be the sole candidate for election.

Czechoslovakia then received

Continued on Page 6, Column 6

OPTIMISM VOICED

American Complicity
Denied but a Key Role
Is Acknowledged

By MAX FRANKEL

Special to The New York Times

WASHINGTON, Saturday, Nov. 2.—The Administration welcomed the coup d'état in South Vietnam, assuming that its policies helped to bring it about and is confident of greater progress now in the war against the Communist guerrillas.

There were, of course, no public statements to this effect even after the success of the coup appeared certain this morning. Officials denied any direct involvement in the military plot and are likely to deplore the deaths of President Ngo Dinh Diem and his brother Ngo Dinh Nhu if reports of their deaths are confirmed.

It is conceded here, however, that the United States Government had created the atmosphere that made the coup possible. This had been done by President Kennedy's public denunciation of President Ngo Dinh Diem and by constant pressure from Washington for



Heavy fighting was reported at the Presidential Palace (1) in Saigon. Anti-Government forces seized the Defense Ministry (2) and police and navy headquarters (3 and 4).

PALACE BESIEGED

Army, Air Force and
Marines Combine to
Oust President

Continued on Page 4

By HEDRICK SMITH

Special to The New York Times

WASHINGTON, Saturday, Nov. 2.—The South Vietnamese Government of President Ngo Dinh Diem has fallen in a swift military coup d'état.

The insurgents reported over the Saigon radio this morning that Ngo Dinh Diem and his powerful brother Ngo Dinh Nhu had committed suicide.

High officials here confirmed that President Ngo Dinh Diem surrendered to the rebels at 6:05 P.M. Friday, New York time, and that the brothers were arrested. There was no official confirmation of the suicide report, which was relayed by the United States Embassy in Saigon.

Anti-Red Drive Promised

New York Times reporting assassination of President Diem



US military advisor training South Vietnamese troops in 1962.

Escalation Of The Conflict Under Johnson

Source: TV Interview with President Johnson in which Johnson Endorses the "Domino Theory," 15 March 1964, (Public Papers of The Presidents, Johnson, 1963-64, p. 370)

Mr. Severeid: "Mr. Kennedy said, on the subject of Vietnam, I think, that he did believe in the 'falling domino' theory, that if Vietnam were lost, that other countries in the area would soon be lost."

The President: "I think it would be a very dangerous thing, and I share President Kennedy's view, and I think the whole of Southeast Asia would be involved and that would involve hundreds of millions of people, and I think it's-it cannot be ignored, we must do everything that we can, we must be responsible, we must stay there and help them, and that is what we are going to do."

Source: President Lyndon B. Johnson's 'President's Message to Congress,' 5 August 1964. Johnson is discussing the recent Gulf of Tonkin incident.

Last night I announced to the American people that the North Vietnamese regime had conducted further deliberate attacks against U.S. naval vessels operating in international waters, and therefore directed air action against gunboats and supporting facilities used in these hostile operations. This air action has now been carried out with substantial damage to the boats and facilities. Two U.S. aircraft were lost in the action. After consultation with the leaders of both parties in the Congress, I further announced a decision to ask the Congress for a resolution expressing the unity and determination of the United States in supporting freedom and in protecting peace in southeast Asia.

In recent months, the actions of the North Vietnamese regime have become steadily more threatening. In May, following new acts of communist aggression in Laos, the United States undertook reconnaissance flights over Laotian territory, at the request of the Government of Laos. These flights had the essential mission of determining the situation in territory where communist forces were preventing inspection by the International Control Commission. When the communists attacked these aircraft, I responded by furnishing escort fighters with instructions to fire when fired upon. Thus, these latest North Vietnamese attacks on our naval vessels are not the first direct attack on armed forces of the United States. As President of the United States I have concluded that I should now ask the Congress, on its part, to join in affirming the national determination that all such attacks will be met, and that the United States will continue in its basic policy of assisting the free nations of the area to defend their freedom.



American soldiers wade through Vietnamese marshland, 1965.



American soldiers in Vietnam, 1965.

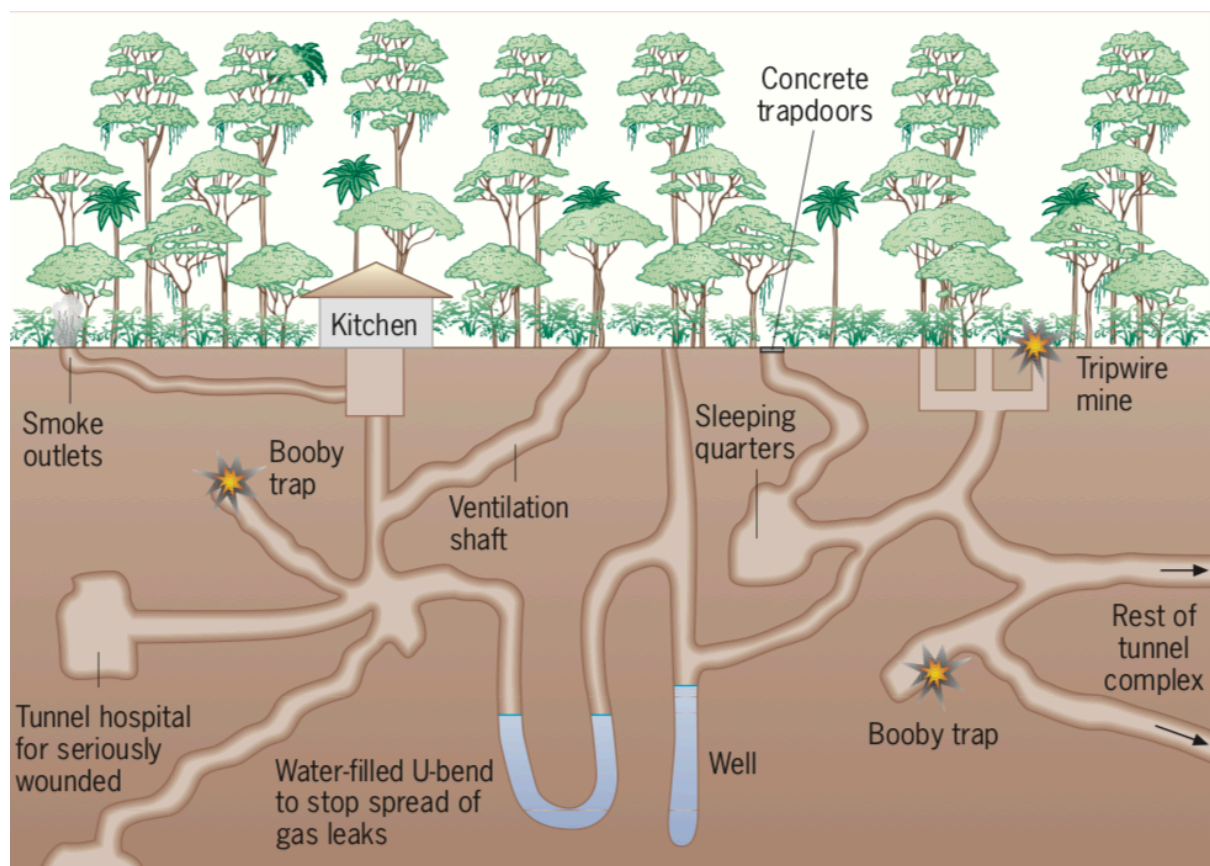
The Nature Of The Conflict In Vietnam, 1964-68

Source: American intelligence officer discussing the treatment of Vietcong suspects during the conflict. (Ken Coates (editor), *Prevent the Crime of Silence: Reports from the Sessions of the International War Crimes tribunal*)

I never knew an individual to be detained as a VC suspect who ever lived through an interrogation... and that included quite a number of individuals... They all died. There was never any reasonable establishment of the fact that any of those individuals was, in fact, cooperating with the Vietcong, but they all died and the majority were either tortured to death or things like thrown from helicopters.

Source: American housewife who travelled to Vietnam and visited several hospitals in order to adopt Vietnamese children.

I had heard and read that napalm melts the flesh, and I thought that's nonsense, because I can put a roast in the oven and the fat will melt but the meat stays there. Well, I went and saw these children burned by napalm, and it's absolutely true. The chemical reaction of this napalm does melt the flesh, and the flesh runs right down their faces onto their chests and it sits there and grows there... These children can't turn their heads, they were so thick with flesh... And when gangrene sets in, they cut off their hands or fingers or their feet.



Example of a Viet Cong tunnel complex, which was utilised to avoid American bombing from the air.



Vietcong laying a fatal trap for incoming American troops.



American troops lower a fellow soldier into a Vietcong tunnel during a search and destroy mission, April 1967.



American soldiers dragging a member of the Vietcong, 1966



Edmund Valtman's cartoon depicting the threat that simple guerrilla warfare posed to the militarily superior United States.

Source: President Richard Nixon, Vietnamization Speech (November 3, 1969)

In the previous administration, we Americanized the war in Vietnam. In this administration, we are Vietnamizing the search for peace. The policy of the previous administration not only resulted in our assuming the primary responsibility for fighting the war, but even more significantly did not adequately stress the goal of strengthening the South Vietnamese so that they could defend themselves when we left. The Vietnamization plan was launched following Secretary Laird's visit to Vietnam in March. Under the plan, I ordered first a substantial increase in the training and equipment of South Vietnamese forces. In July, on my visit to Vietnam, I changed General Abrams' orders so that they were consistent with the objectives of our new policies. Under the new orders, the primary mission of our troops is to enable the South Vietnamese forces to assume the full responsibility for the security of South Vietnam. Our air operations have been reduced by over 20 percent. And now we have begun to see the results of this long overdue change in American policy in Vietnam.

- *After 5 years of Americans going into Vietnam, we are finally bringing American men home. By December 15, over 60,000 men will have been withdrawn from South Vietnam - including 20 percent of all of our combat forces.*
- *The South Vietnamese have continued to gain in strength. As a result they have been able to take over combat responsibilities from our American troops.*

Source: President Richard Nixon, 'Address to the Nation on Progress Towards Peace in Vietnam,' (April 20 1970)

However, despite this new enemy activity, there has been an overall decline in enemy force levels in South Vietnam since December. As the enemy force levels have declined and as the South Vietnamese have assumed more of the burden of battle, American casualties have declined.

I am glad to be able to report tonight that in the first 3 months of 1970, the number of Americans killed in action dropped to the lowest first quarter level in 5 years.

In June, a year ago, when we began troop withdrawals, we did so on a "cut and try" basis--with no certainty that the program would be successful. In June we announced withdrawal of 25,000 American troops; in September another 35,000 and then in December 50,000 more. These withdrawals have now been completed and as of April 15, a total of 115,500 men have returned home from Vietnam.

We have now reached a point where we can confidently move from a period of "cut and try" to a longer-range program for the replacement of Americans by South Vietnamese troops.

I am, therefore, tonight announcing plans for the withdrawal of an additional 150,000 American troops to be completed during the spring of next year. This will bring a total reduction of 265,500 men in our Armed Forces in Vietnam below the level that existed when we took office 15 months ago.

Source: New York Times, 'Nixon Sends Combat Forces To Cambodia To Drive Communists From Staging Zone' (May 1 1970)

In a sharp departure from the previous conduct of war in South east Asia, President Nixon announced tonight that he was sending United States combat troops into Cambodia for the first time. Even as the President was addressing the nation on television, several thousand American soldiers were moving across the border from South Vietnam to Cambodia to attack what Mr. Nixon described as “the headquarters for the entire Communist military operation in South Vietnam.”

... “Our purpose is not to occupy the areas,” the President declared. “Once enemy forces are driven out of these sanctuaries and their military supplies destroyed, we will withdraw.”

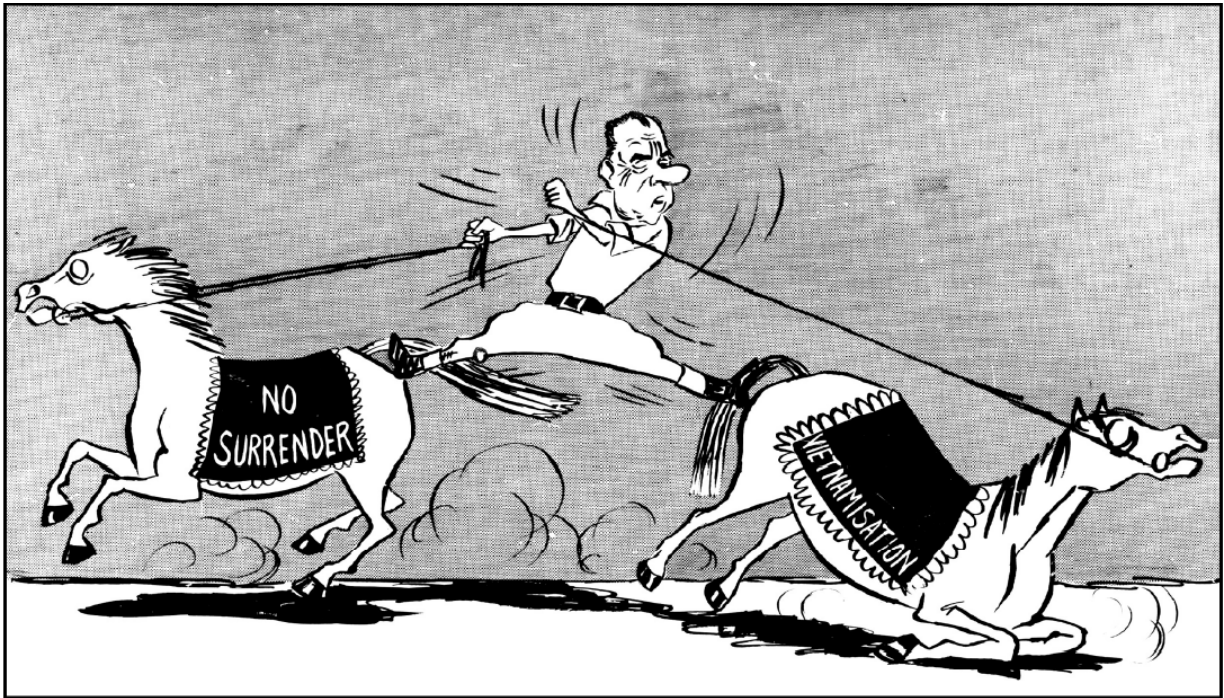
The President described the action as “not an invasion of Cambodia” but a necessary extension of the Vietnam war designed to eliminate a major Communist staging and communications area. Thus it is intended to protect the lives of American troops and shorten the war, he asserted. The President further described the action as “indispensable” for the continued success of his program of Vietnamization — under which he has been withdrawing American ground combat troops as the burden of fighting is gradually shifted to the South Vietnamese. The President's rhetoric was tough—probably the toughest of his tenure in office—and was reminiscent of some of the speeches of Lyndon B. Johnson during the last years of his term as President.



Soldier training South Vietnamese troops during Vietnamisation



American cartoon, published in 1972. The crows represent the Communist forces.



British cartoon from 1969 commenting on Richard Nixon's policies in Vietnam.



President Richard Nixon announcing the entry of American soldiers into Cambodia during a press conference. 30 April 1970.

**Key Topic 4: Reactions to, and the end of, US involvement
in Vietnam, 1964-75**

Opposition To The War

Source: Todd Gitlin, founding member of the Students for a Democratic Society (SDS), an integral anti-war group. Here, Gitlin discusses an anti-Vietnam War protest in Washington, April 1965.

We scheduled the (antiwar) demonstration for April 17, 1965 in Washington D.C., but nobody thought it would be very large. SDS was still a tiny organization with maybe two thousand members and Vietnam was not very much on anybody's horizon... So when I got on a bus in Ann Arbor on April 16, I felt I would be happy to see five thousand people. When we rolled in Washington I remember seeing great flocks of buses parked along the mall, scores of them. It was a sunrise experience and it was staggering. I thought, we're in business, we're rolling. The antiwar movement is going to be really substantial. It will be a real contest. We had maybe twenty-five thousand people and everything about it felt good.

Source: Carol Mirman, student at Kent State University in 1970. Here, Mirman discusses her memories of the shootings on May 4 1970.

And then I heard a single shot. And then there was a volley. I was very close to the Guard and the bullets whizzed past my ears. I was very much in the line of fire. I do recall -- some of those things are sort of burned in my memory. I remember thinking so clearly when that volley went by my ears, "This is not what it sounds like on TV. This is not what the sound of bullets sound like on cartoons." It was a very different sound, the bullets so close to one's head, to one's ears. Very different sound. And I jumped over bodies and ran down the hill. I also recall some students saying "Walk, don't run. They're only blanks." And I remember thinking "Huh? Why carry a weapon if you don't have something in it that's intended to work." I'm outta here. And I did. I ran over bodies two, three deep were hittin' the ground. And so I ran down the hill to a place of safety, but by the time I was behind that yellow Volkswagen which was right near where Jeff Miller was shot, the volley had stopped. I got up when the volley had stopped to look to see what the heck had happened. And I did see Jeff Miller at that time -- and -- that's when the photograph of me was taken by Jeff Miller. I'd never seen blood like that. I'd never seen anything like that. It was a complete shock. I wanted to touch him. I remember wanting to hold him, but I was afraid of the blood. I did touch him, I did touch and hold his hand. 'Cause I didn't want him to feel alone. I figured how can anybody live with this, his life was running down the sidewalk. Running. Just kept flowing. And there was nothing to be done, that I felt I could do.

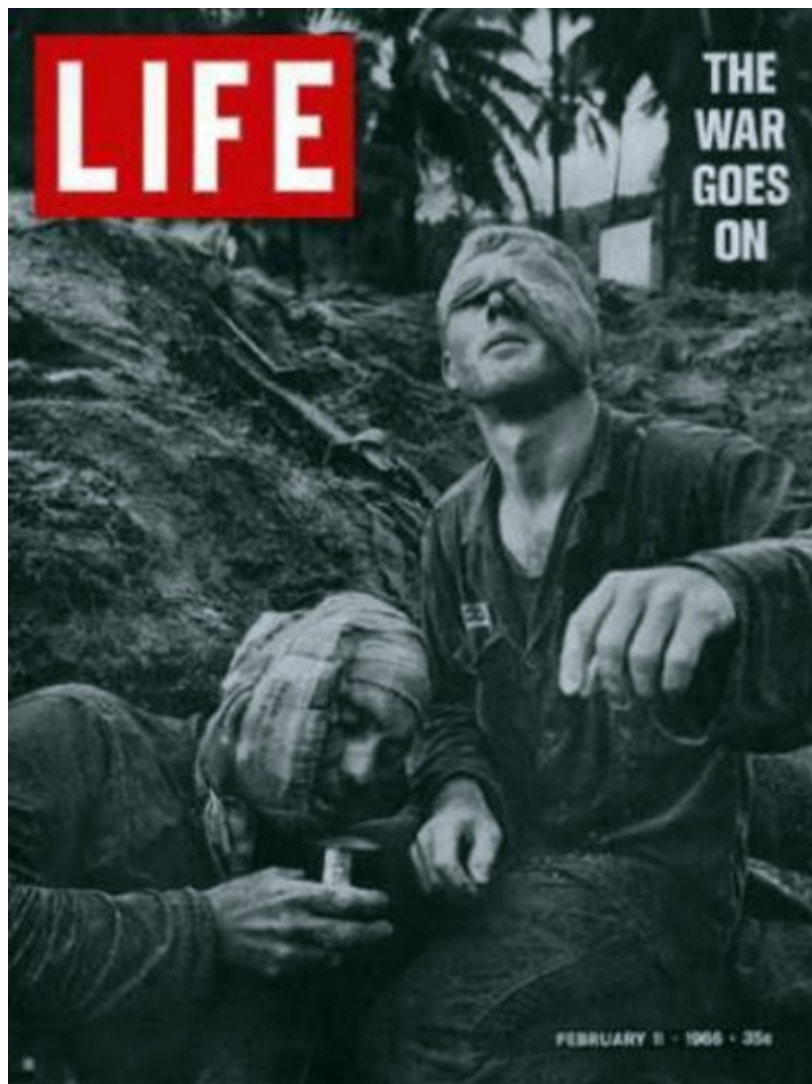
Source: Naval officer and Vietnam veteran John Kerry speaks before the Senate Foreign Relations Committee about the horrors of the war.

Several months ago in Detroit we had an investigation at which over 150 honorably discharged, and many very highly decorated, veterans testified to war crimes committed in South-East Asia. These were not isolated incidents but crimes committed on a day to day basis with a full awareness of officers at all levels of command. They told stories that at times they had personally raped, cut-off ears, cutoff heads, taped wires from portable telephones to human genitals and turned up the power, cutoff limbs, blown up bodies, randomly shot at civilians, razed villages in a fashion reminiscent of Genghis Khan, shot cattle and dogs for fun, poisoned food stocks, and generally ravaged the countryside of South Vietnam...

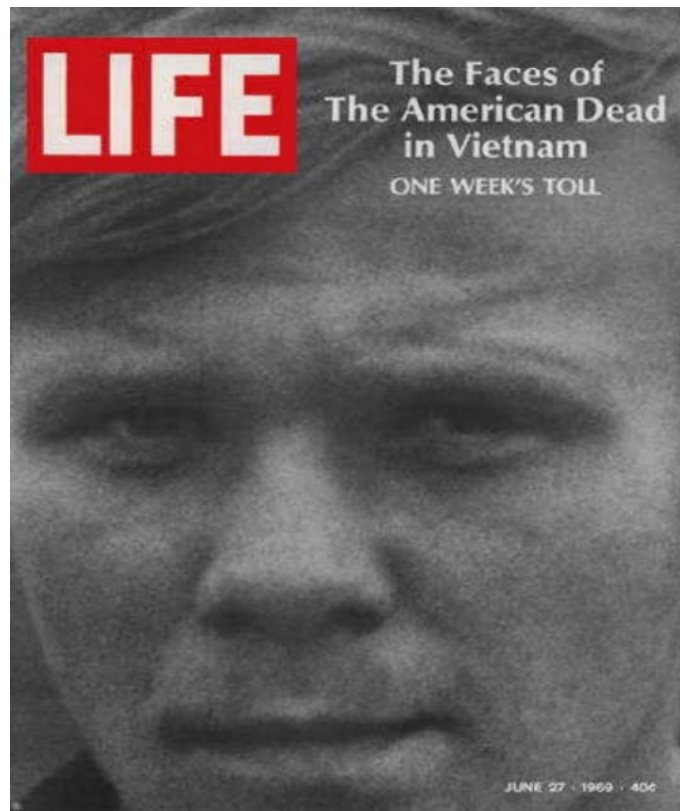
I would like to talk to you a little bit about what the result is of the feelings these men carry with them after coming back from Vietnam. The country doesn't know it yet but it has created a monster, a monster in the form of millions of men who have been taught to deal and trade in violence.

Source: Bob Dylan, 'Masters of War.' Within this song, Dylan rallies against US involvement overseas (1963)

*You fasten all the triggers
For the others to fire
Then you set back and watch
When the death count gets higher
You hide in your mansion'
As young people's blood
Flows out of their bodies
And is buried in the mud*



Life Magazine, depicting two injured American soldiers. (Feb 1966)



Life Magazine, June 27, 1969. This issue depicted the 242 soldiers who had died in Vietnam between May 28 and June 3.



Anti-war protestors confront military police. October 21, 1967.



A student is shot during the events at Kent State University on May 4 1970.

Support For The War

Source: President Richard Nixon, 'Address to the Nation on the War in Vietnam' (3 November 1969)

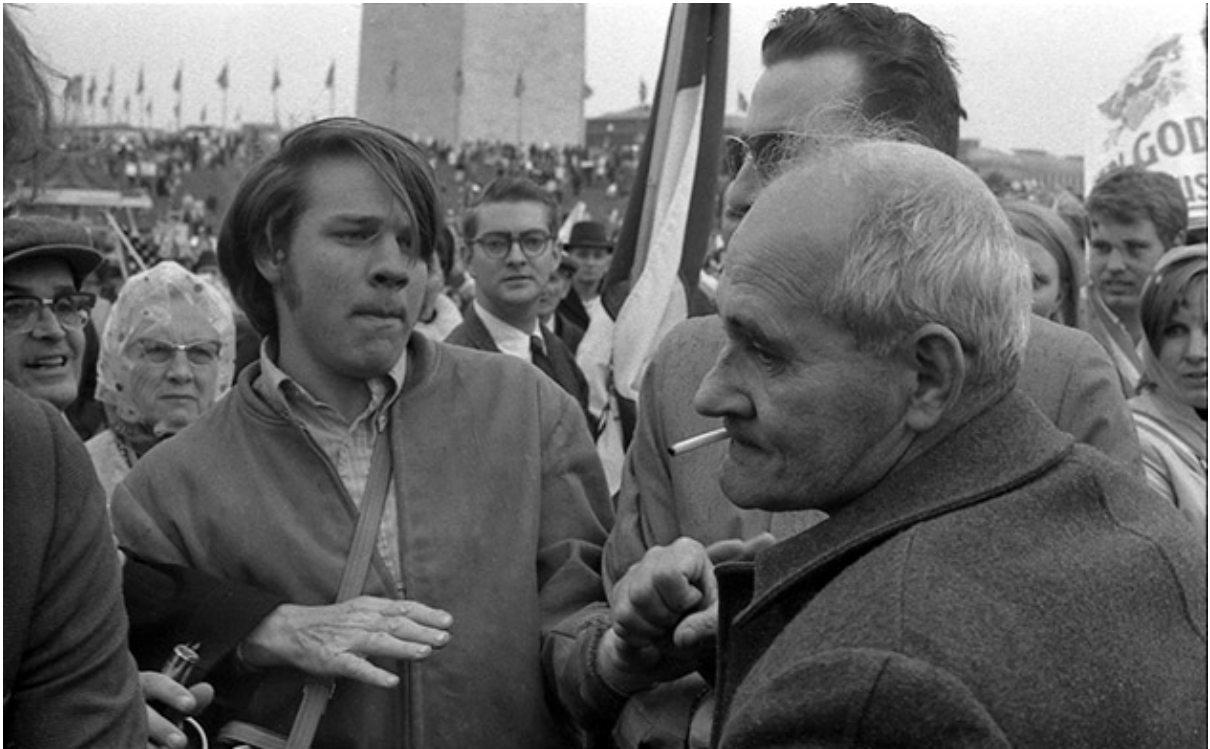
In San Francisco a few weeks ago, I saw demonstrators carrying signs reading: "Lose in Vietnam, bring the boys home."

Well, one of the strengths of our free society is that any American has a right to reach that conclusion and to advocate that point of view. But as President of the United States, I would be untrue to my oath of office if I allowed the policy of this Nation to be dictated by the minority who hold that point of view and who try to impose it on the Nation by mounting demonstrations in the street.

And so tonight-to you, the great silent majority of my fellow Americans-I ask for your support.



Demonstrators march at the Washington Monument in support of the Vietnam War in 1970.



A man is restrained as he prepares to take a swing at a young anti-war protestor.



Pro and anti-war protestors confront one another in California, 1966



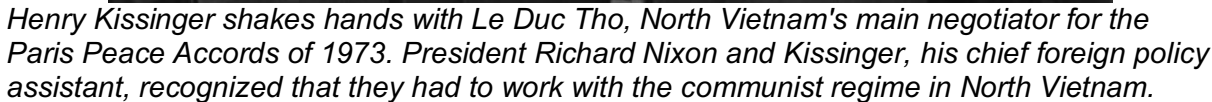
President Nixon and his chief-of-staff the day after the president's November 3, 1969 speech on the Vietnam War. The Oval Office desk was stacked with hundreds of telegrams and letters of support from the general public.



'Hard Hat' riots of 1970. Anti and pro-Vietnam War protestors scuffle with one another.



Construction workers rally, 20 May 1970, in an attempt to oppose anti-war sentiment.



New York Times reporting on the Paris Peace Agreement of 1973